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SECT 01 OF 55280

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TRANSIT/051933Z/052030Z/000157TOR0952013

DE RUEHOTA #1692 0951940

ZNR UUUUU

R 051933Z APR 78

FM USDAO/OTTAWA

TO RUEKJCS/DIA WASHDC

INFO RUENAAA/CNO WASHDC

RUEOAJD/NISC WASHDC

RUEBARA/COMNAVINTCOM WASHDC

RULSSAA/ONR ARLINGTON VA

RUEBJHA/NRL WASHDC

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UNCLAS SECTION 01 OF 02 USDAO/OTTAWA 01692

CITE: USDAO 250 APR 78

SUBJ: THIS IS IN NO. 6 015 0085 78

1. COUNTRY: CANADA (CA)

2. REPORT NUMBER: 6 015 0085 78

3. TITLE: BOOMS, BANGS AND BALLS OF FIRE

4. PROJECT NUMBER: N/A

5. DATE OF INFORMATION: 780403

6. DATE OF REPORT: 780404

7. DATE & PLACE OF ACQUISITION: 780403; OTTAWA, CANADA

8. REFERENCES: INITIATIVE

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9. ASSESSMENT: B-2

10. ORIGINATOR: USDAO, OTTAWA, CANADA

11. REQUEST EVALUATION: NO

12. PREPARING OFFICER: JOSEPH L. DICK, CAPT, USN, NAVAL ATTACHE

13. APPROVING AUTHORITY: WILLIAM W. VON HAUSEN, COL, USAF, DEFENSE ATTACHE

14. SOURCE: "THE GLOBE AND MAIL," TORONTO NEWSPAPER

15. SPECIAL INSTRUCTIONS: NONE. DIRC: NO

16. SUMMARY: THE FOLLOWING NEWSPAPER ARTICLE IS QUOTED IN FULL IN ORDER TO PROVIDE AS MUCH DETAIL AS POSSIBLE TO INVESTIGATORS AT THE NAVAL RESEARCH LABORATORY COLLECTING DATA ON THIS TYPE OF PHENOMENA:

"ST. JOHN'S--BELL ISLANDERS ARE STILL TRYING TO FIGURE OUT WHAT HIT THEIR COMMUNITY OFF THE EAST COAST OF NEWFOUNDLAND YESTERDAY, TEARING APART HOUSES, CUTTING OFF POWER, POPPING LIGHT SWITCHES AND LEAVING THREE MYSTERIOUS HOLES BURNED IN THE GROUND.

"IT WAS FIRST DESCRIBED AS AN UNIDENTIFIED ATMOSPHERIC EXPLOSION AND SOUNDED SIMILAR TO THE SONIC BOOMS THAT HAVE BEEN HEARD IN RECENT MONTHS ALONG THE COAST OF NOVA SCOTIA AND NEW ENGLAND.

"AS IN THOSE INCIDENTS, THE SUPERSONIC CONCORDE AIRLINER WAS FIRST SUGGESTED AS AN EXPLANATION. THAT THEORY HAS BEEN QUICKLY DISMISSED.

"ONE DIFFERENCE BETWEEN THE NEWFOUNDLAND PHENOMENON AND THE NOVA SCOTIA BOOMS IS THAT YESTERDAY'S BLAST WAS CENTRED OVER A POPULATED AREA. LANCE COVE, A SMALL COMMUNITY ON BELL ISLAND IN CONCEPTION BAY, WAS THE CENTRE OF THE ENERGY BURST AND WITH THIS INCIDENT THE SOUND WAS THE LEAST SPECTACULAR OF THE EFFECTS.

"A HOUSE WAS TORN UP AS IF IT HAD BEEN HIT BY LIGHTNING, BUT THERE WERE NO BURN MARKS ANYWHERE. A TELEVISION SET EXPLODED, OUTLETS EXPLODED IN THE WALL.

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"I CAN'T TELL YOU WHAT HAPPENED," MR. BECKFORD SAID. "I HEARD A RACKET, THAT'S ALL I CAN CALL IT, A RACKET. THIS THING BROKE OVER THE HOUSE. I'VE WORKED IN THE MINES AND WE HAVE SHOT 300 PLUGS OF POWDER AT ONE TIME, AND THERE WAS NEVER A RACKET LIKE THAT."

"HIS DAUGHTER CYNTHIA SAID LIGHT SWITCHES FLEW OUT OF THE WALL AND "WHATEVER IT WAS PASSED RIGHT THROUGH THE HOUSE AND DOWN TO THE BARN. THE SKY LIT RIGHT UP. AND YOU COULD SEE SMOKE IN THE WOODS."

"IN THE WOODS BEHIND MR. BECKFORD'S BARN THERE ARE THREE HOLES IN THE SNOW. THEY'RE CIRCULAR HOLES ABOUT ONE AND ONE-HALF FEET DEEP AND THEY FORM A TRIANGLE.

"THEY WEREN'T THERE BEFORE. THAT THING MADE THEM," HE SAID.

"CAROL O'BRIEN SAID SHE HAS SEEN "SOME BEAUTIFUL SUNSETS BUT NOTHING LIKE THAT LIGHT." MISS O'BRIEN SAID SHE HEARD THREE BLASTS AND THAT THE GROUND SHOOK WITH EACH BLAST. AS IN ALL THE OTHER HOUSES ON BELL ISLAND THE POWER IN HER HOUSE WENT OUT JUST BEFORE THE FIRST EXPLOSION.

"THE YOUNG FELLOW HAD THE PHONE IN HIS HAND AND THE RECEIVER JUST DROPPED OUT OF HIS HAND," SHE SAID. "SPARKS CAME OUT OF THE OVEN. IT CAME RIGHT THROUGH THE GLASS." AS WITH MOST PEOPLE SHE INSISTS THE NOISE WAS NOT ORDINARY THUNDER.

"THE RCMP SAID PEOPLE ON THE MAINLAND SHORE OF CONCEPTION BAY REPORTED SEEING FIREBALLS COMING DOWN OUT OF THE SKY AND HITTING BELL ISLAND. BARBARA MCKIM OF CHAMBERLAINS,

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DE RUEHOTA #1692 0951948

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FOUR MILES FROM BELL ISLAND ACROSS OPEN WATER, SAID THERE WERE "STREAKS OF SUPER BRIGHT SILVERY WHITE LIGHT."

"THE AUTHORITIES ARE ATTEMPTING TO PLAY DOWN THE INCIDENT. THEIR OFFICIAL VERSION OF WHAT HAPPENED IS THAT LIGHTNING HIT A TRANSFORMER ON BELL ISLAND, BLEW UP AND THE ENERGY THEN FOLLOWED THE WIRES TO NEIGHBORING HOUSES.

"BUT THE EXPLOSION WAS HEARD FROM WESTERN BAY, ON THE NORTH SHORE OF CONCEPTION BAY, SOUTH AS FAR AS CAPE BROYLE, A DISTANCE OF MORE THAN 100 KILOMETRES."

COMMENT: THIS IS THE SECOND EVENT OF ROOMS OFF THE EAST

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COAST IN THE PAST TWO MONTHS. ABOUT SIX WEEKS AGO, A BOOM WAS REPORTED OCCURRING OVER THE VICINITY OF BARRINGTON, NOVA SCOTIA. A CORRELATION OF THIS EVENT TO THE FLIGHT SCHEDULE OF THE CONCORDE, WHICH FLIES IN ITS NORMAL TRANSIT JUST OFF THE SOUTHERN TIP OF NOVA SCOTIA, WAS MADE BY THE MINISTRY OF TRANSPORTATION (MOT). THERE WAS SOME CORRELATION AS TO TIME, BUT THE RESULTS WERE NOT CONCLUSIVE. MOT IS CONTINUING THEIR INVESTIGATION. THE ATMOSPHERIC AND ENVIRONMENTAL SERVICE IS SEEKING ADDITIONAL INFORMATION ON THE BELLE ISLE EVENT, INCLUDING MORE DETAILED WEATHER INFORMATION. IT HAS BEEN CONFIRMED THAT THERE WAS NO THUNDERSTORM ACTIVITY IN THAT AREA AT THE TIME BUT THAT IT WAS SNOWING. THE IMPRESSIONS OR HOLES IN THE GROUND HAVE BEEN CONFIRMED TO BE TWO FEET IN DIAMETER AND ABOUT TWO FEET DEEP. SOME TREES WERE SCORCHED IN THIS VICINITY. THERE IS SOME THOUGHT BEING GIVEN TO THE POSSIBILITY OF A METEORITE ENTRY. ONE SOURCE EXPLAINS "THAT THESE EXPLOSIONS ARE CAUSED BY THE VOLATILITY OF THE AIR ITSELF WITH WHICH THERE IS ASSOCIATED AN ELECTRICAL PHENOMENON. IT IS NOT PRECIPITATED BY ATOMIC EXPLOSIONS OR FLYING SAUCERS BUT MAY BE CATALYZED BY HIGH PERFORMANCE AIRCRAFT."

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